

CHAPTER

38



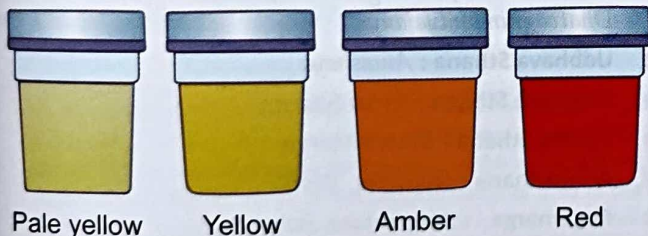
Prameha

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To learn the concept of Prameha
- ⇒ To learn about the Pratyatma Lakshana (cardinal feature) of Prameha
- ⇒ To learn the Nidana and Samprapti of Prameha mentioned in Ayurveda literatures
- ⇒ To frame out the probable Samprapti Ghataka based on the progression of the disease
- ⇒ To enlist the types of Prameha
- ⇒ To learn about Purvarupa, Vishishsta Lakshana, Upadrava and Sadhyasadyata of Prameha

Introduction

Urine colors



Hematuria

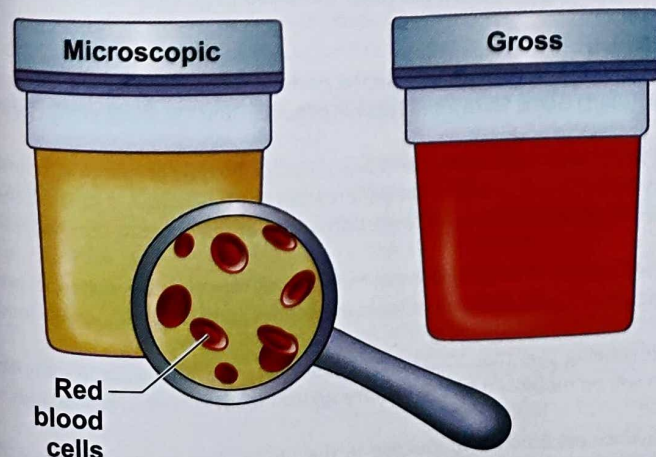


Figure 162: Pratyatma Lakshana of Prameha

Prameha is a spectrum of diseases which involve primarily *Medovaha Srotas* along with the involvement of *Mutravaha Srotas*. This is characterised by *Prabhuta Mutrata* (increased quantity of urine) and *Avila Mutrata* (turbidity of urine). All *Ayurveda* literatures described 20 types of *Prameha*. *Sushruta* has classified this disease in *Adibala Pravritta Vikara* of *Adhyatmika Vikara*. As per *Charaka*, *Prameha* is considered to be *Anushangi Vikara* i.e. the disease which will more closely attached to the individual. In this context, *Prabhuta Mutrata* is self explanatory where in the amount of urine passed in either one frequency or in 24 hours is increased. The term *Avila Mutrata* refers to turbid urine. This is quite different from simple water as this fluid contains several other metabolites such as urea, uric acid, creatinine, pus cells, red blood cells, casts and crystals etc. In case of abnormal conditions, urine contains sugar, proteins, ketone bodies, red blood cells, bile salts, bile pigments etc. The nature of *Avilatva* (turbidity) differs in different disease manifestations. Thus, *Prameha* is the spectrum of diseases where in person will have passage of excess amount of turbid urine. *Amashaya* is the *Udbhava Sthana* of the disease, *Sanchara Sthana* is *Sarvasharira* and *Vyakta Sthana* is *Mutra*. *Atipravritti* is the type of *Srotodushti* observed in the whole progression of the disease.

Nirukti

प्रकर्षेण प्रभूतं प्रचुरं वारंवारं वा मूत्रत्यागं करोति यस्मिन् रोगे स प्रमेहः॥

मा.नि. - 33/1, मधु

Prameha is considered to be associated with increased frequency of micturition. This could in terms of increased flow at a time or increased frequency at a time or increase in overall output in a day.

Nidana of Prameha

आस्यासुखं स्वप्नसुखं दधीनि ग्राम्यौदकानूपरसाः पयांसि।
नवान्नपानं गुडवैकृतं च प्रमेहेतुः कफकृच्च सर्वम्॥4॥

Ca.Ci. - 6/4

- Performing the activities in sitting posture or comfortable posture most of the times¹
- Excess sleeping in a day²
- Excess intake of curds
- Excess intake of meat and meat soup of domestic, marshy and aquatic animals such as chicken, pork and fish
- Excess intake of milk and milk products
- Excess intake of freshly harvested food grains³
- Excess intake of freshly prepared alcohol⁴
- Excess intake of jaggery and products of jaggery
- Excess intake of substances which lead to the vitiation of *Kapha Dosha*⁵

Samprapti⁶ of Prameha

मेदश्च मांसं च शरीरजं च क्लेदं कफो बस्तिगतं प्रदृष्य।
करोति मेहान् समुदीर्णमुष्णै- स्तानेव पित्तं परिदृष्य चापि॥5॥
क्षीणेषु दोषेष्ववकृष्य बस्ती धातून् प्रमेहाननिलः करोति।
दोषो हि वस्तिं समुपेत्य मूत्रं संदृष्य मेहाञ्जनयेद्यथास्वम्॥6॥

Ca.Ci. - 6/5,6

Dosha and Dushya of Prameha

कफः सपित्तः पवनश्च दोषा मेदोस्त्रशुक्राम्बुवसालसीकाः।

- 1 This implies the person will have reduced muscle mass and increased adipose tissue in the body. This occurs when the person is having frequent consumption of carbohydrate rich diet and he is doing less physical activity. When the person is having insulin deficiency, sugar present in the blood circulation cannot be utilised by the cells of the human body and when the renal threshold of glucose increases >180 mg/dl will lead to the appearance of sugar in the urine.
- 2 Excess amount of sleep will have a similar action as that of sedentary lifestyle.
- 3 All the above said etiological factors are known to be responsible for the vitiation of *Kapha Dosha* in the body as most of the substances are having *Madhura Rasa* (sweet taste), *Guru* (heavy to digest), *Snigdha* (unctuous) *Guna*, *Shita Virya* (cold in potency) and *Madhura Vipaka* (end product of digestion is *Madhura*).
- 4 As per *Ayurveda* literatures, *Madya* (intoxicating beverages) are having *Amla Rasa*, *Ushna Virya* and *Amla Vipaka*. Freshly prepared alcoholic beverages likely to increase the *Kapha Dosha* in the body. Chronic calcifying pancreatitis and acute pancreatitis are the serious complications seen in the patients of chronic alcoholism. Thus, the person may show disturbances of insulin secretion and that may lead to the manifestation of diabetes mellitus.
- 5 All the above said etiological factors are known to be responsible for the vitiation of *Kapha Dosha* in the body as most of the substances are having *Madhura Rasa* (sweet taste), *Guru* (heavy to digest), *Snigdha* (unctuous) *Guna*, *Shita Virya* (cold in potency) and *Madhura Vipaka* (end product of digestion is *Madhura*).
- 6 When an individual is suffering from *Prameha* spectrum of diseases, it is being said that *Medas* (fat tissue), *Mamsa* (muscular tissue) and *Shariraja Kleda* (in the present context, fluid of abnormal constituents) will be mobilised to the urinary system leading to the manifestation of clinical features of *Prameha*.
When a person is suffering from diabetes mellitus, the person will have excess amount of glucose in the blood. Due to the deficiency of insulin, the glucose cannot be utilised by the body parts. This will lead to the mobilisation of stored fat into the circulation, mobilisation of proteins stored in the muscular tissue, and intermediary metabolic products of fat and proteins can be observed in the blood. These intermediary metabolic products can be taken as abnormal *Kleda* in the body.

मज्जा रसोजः पिशितं च दृष्याः प्रमेहिणां विंशतिरेव मेहाः॥8॥

Ca.Ci. - 6/8

- Due to the exposure to etiological factors, *Medas*, *Mamsa* and *Kleda* of the body will be moved to *Basti* by vitiated *Kapha Dosha*.
- Due to the increase of *Ushna Guna* in the body by the exposure to *Pitta* vitiating factors, *Medas*, *Mamsa* and *Kleda* of the body will be moved to *Basti* by vitiated *Pitta Dosha*.
- Due to the decrease of other *Dosha*, *Vata Dosha* will get vitiated and this vitiated *Vata Dosha* will move the abnormal *Dhatu* to *Basti* region leading to the manifestation of *Vataja Prameha*.
- *Medas*, *Rakta*, *Mamsa*, *Ambu*, *Vasa*, *Lasika*, *Majja*, *Rasa*, *Ojas*, *Shukra* are the other components of the body get vitiated in the patient of *Prameha* disease.

Samprapti Ghataka

- **Dosha** : *Kapha Pradhana*, association of *Pitta* or *Vata* can be seen in due course of time
- **Dushya** : *Rasa*, *Rakta*, *Mamsa*, *Medas*, *Majja*, *Shukra*, *Ojas*, *Vasa*, *Ambu*, *Lasika*, *Mutra* in different stages of the illness
- **Srotas**: *Medovaha* and *Mutravaha Srotas*
- **Srotodushti Prakara** : *Atipravritti*
- **Agni** : *Jatharagnimandya* and *Medo Dhatvagnimandya*
- **Ama** : *Jatharagnimandya* and *Medo Dhatvagnimandya*
- **Udbhava Sthana** : *Amashaya*
- **Sanchara Sthana** : *Sarva Sharira*
- **Vyakta Sthana** : *Mutra Marga*
- **Adhishtana** : *Sharirika*, *Basti*
- **Rogamarga** : *Abhyantara*, *Bahya*

- Vyadhi Svabhava : Chirakari
- Sadhyasadyata : Yapy to Asadya

Purvarupa of Prameha

स्वेदोऽन्धः शिथिलाङ्गता च शय्यासनस्वप्नसुखे रतिश्च।
नेत्रजिह्वाश्रवणोपदेहो घनाङ्गता केशनखातिवृद्धिः॥13॥
शीतप्रियत्वं गलतालुशोषो माधुर्यमास्ये करपाददाहः।
भविष्यतो मेहगदस्य रूपं मूत्रेऽभिधावन्ति पिपीलिकाञ्च॥ 14॥

Ca.Ci. – 6/13,14

दन्तादीनां मलाढ्यत्वं प्राग्रूपं पाणिपादयोः।
दाहश्चिकणता देहे तृट् स्वाद्वास्यं च जायते॥15॥

Ma.Ni. – 33/5

त्रयस्तु खलु दोषाः प्रकुपिताः प्रमेहानभिनिर्वर्त- यिष्यन्त इमानि
पूर्वरूपाणि दर्शयन्ति तद्यथा - जटि- लीभावं केशेषु, माधुर्यमास्यस्य,
करपादयोः सुप्तता- दाहो, मुखतालुकण्ठशोषं, पिपासाम्, आलस्यं,
मलं काये, कायच्छिद्रेषूपदेहं परिदाहं सुप्ततां चाङ्गेषु, षट्पदपिपीलि
काभिश्च शरीरमूत्राभिसरणं, मूत्रे च मूत्रदोषान् वित्रं शरीरगन्धं, निद्रां
तन्द्रां च सर्व- कालमिति॥47॥

Ca.Ni. – 4/47

- Excess sweating⁷
- Foul smell from body parts⁸
- Looseness of the body parts⁹
- Liking towards sleeping for long time
- Liking towards sitting for long time¹⁰
- Coating over the Hridaya region¹¹
- Coating over the eyes¹²
- Coating over the tongue¹³

- Accumulation of wax in the ears¹⁴
- Hard body parts¹⁵
- Excess growth of scalp hairs¹⁶
- Excess growth of nails
- Affinity towards consumption of cold substances
- Dryness of the throat
- Dryness of the palate¹⁷
- Sweetish taste in the mouth
- Burning sensation and numbness in the palms and soles¹⁸
- Appearance of the ants near the person does micturition¹⁹
- Sliminess of the body parts
- Thirst²⁰
- Accumulation of Mala (tartar) over the teeth²¹
- Tangled hair
- Laziness²²
- Excess accumulation of Mala in the body and orifices²³
- Drowsiness all the time
- Increased sleep most of the times²⁴

Pratyatma Lakshana of Prameha

सामान्यं लक्षणं तेषां प्रभूताविलमूत्रता।

Ma.Ni. – 33/6

- Prabhuta Mutrata²⁵ – Increased quantity of urine at a time or increased frequency of micturition or both

- 7 As per Ayurveda literature, Sveda is the Mala of Medo Dhatu. Thus, when the person is suffering from Prameha, he will have profuse sweating which is an outcome of abnormal Medo Dhatu formation.
- 8 When the person is having sweating, most of the water is going to get reabsorbed. It contains urea, lactic acid and potassium ions which are highly concentrated. As far as the concentration of urea in the sweat and plasma is concerned, concentration of urea in the sweat is twice than that of plasma. That may be the reason for the foul smell from the body parts.
- 9 Looseness of the body parts is attributable to the excess loss of adipose and muscular tissue.
- 10 This can be attributable to the sedentary lifestyle.
- 11 This can be attributable to the deposition of circulating fat in the coronary blood vessels.
- 12 This can be attributable to diabetic nephropathy.
- 13 This can be attributable to autonomic nervous dysfunction. Due to this mechanism the person will have poor salivary secretion, which could be major reason for the development of coating over the tongue.
- 14 This is attributable to the increased formation of Mala (waste products) in the body. Wax is considered to be one of Kha-mala which is the biproduct of Mamsa Dhatvagni.
- 15 This is attributable to the reduced adipose and muscular tissue in the suffering individual.
- 16 This can be attributable to the excess and rapid overgrowth of Keshha which is the biproduct of Asthi Dhatvagni function.
- 17 This can be attributable to excess fluid loss from the body which is indicative of hypovolemia.
- 18 This can be attributable to neurological dysfunction.
- 19 This can be attributable to glycosuria i.e. presence of glucose in the urine. When an individual suffering from diabetes mellitus, ants will appear at the site of micturition.
- 20 This is attributable to hypovolemia which is the sequel of polyuria
- 21 This is attributable to increased proliferation of microorganisms which is a sequel of poor oral hygiene.
- 22 This is attributable to sedentary lifestyle.
- 23 This can be attributable to the increased proliferation of microorganisms, in the oral cavity as well as the areas of natural orifices.
- 24 This is attributable to the increase of Kapha Dosha in the body.
- 25 It is a well known fact that urine is passed 7 to 8 times in 24 hours. In one frequency, the amount of urine passed is around 250 ml. In other words to say, on an average, a healthy individual will pass 1,200 to 1,500 ml of urine in 24 hours. If the person passes more than 3,000 ml in 24 hours, that can be termed as polyuria.

• **Avila Mutrata**²⁶ – passage of turbid urine
Sankhya Samprapti of Prameha: 20 types

Kaphaja Prameha – 10

1. *Udaka Meha*
2. *Ikshumeha*
3. *Sandra Meha*
4. *Sura Meha*
5. *Shukla Meha*
6. *Shukra Meha*
7. *Sikata Meha*
8. *Shita Meha*
9. *Shanaih Meha*
10. *Lala Meha*

Pittaja Prameha – 6

1. *Haridra Meha*
2. *Manjishtha Meha*
3. *Kala Meha*
4. *Kshara Meha*
5. *Nila Meha*
6. *Rakta Meha*

Vataja Prameha – 4

1. *Vasa Meha*
2. *Majja Meha*
3. *Hasti Meha*
4. *Kshoudra Meha*

Kaphaja Prameha

अच्छं बहु सितं शीतं निर्गन्धमुदकोपमम्॥7॥
मेहत्युदकमेहेन किंचिदाविलपिच्छिलम्।
इक्षो रसमिवात्यर्थं मधुरं चेधुमेहतः॥8॥
सान्द्रीभवेत् पर्युषितं सान्द्रमेहेन मेहति।
सुरामेही सुरातुल्यमुपर्यच्छमधो धनम्॥9॥
संहृष्टरोमा पिष्टेन पिष्टवद्बहुलं सितम्।
शुक्राभं शुक्रमिश्रं वा शुक्रमेही प्रमेहति॥10॥
मूर्तीणून सिकतामेही सिकतारूपिणो मलान्।
शीतमेही सुबहुशो मधुरं भृशशीतलम्॥11॥
शनैः शनैः शनैर्मेही मन्दं मन्दं प्रमेहति।
लालातन्तुयुतं मूत्रं लालामेहेन पिच्छिलम्॥12॥ Ma.Ni. – 33/7-12

• **Udakameha** – Clear and transparent urine, increased amount of urine formed, colourless, cold and without any smell. The urine resembles water with little turbidity and sliminess.

- **Ikshumeha** – Excess sweetishness, cold, slimy, turbid urine. The urine resembles sugar cane juice.
- **Sandra Meha** – When urine is collected in a container, after sometime, the urine becomes thick and sticky with some amount of sedimentation formed at the bottom of the urine sample
- **Sura Meha** – When urine is collected in a container for sometime, one can observe formation of the sediment at the bottom of the container
- **Sita Meha or Shukla Meha** – Urine appears white in appearance as if the white powder is mixed to the urine. This is associated with horripulation.
- **Shukra Meha** – When a person passes urine, it appears to have mixed with *Shukra* (semen)
- **Shita Meha** – When the person passes urine, it will be excessively sweet, increased amount of urine is passed and it will be cold.
- **Sikata Meha** – When the person passes urine, he will pass small sand like particles in the urine.
- **Shanairmeha** – When the person passes urine, he will pass little quantity of urine with more frequency.
- **Lala Meha** – When the person passes urine, it will be thready, mucoid, slimy urine and is similar to consistency of saliva.

Pittaja Prameha

गन्धवर्णरसस्पर्शैः क्षारेण क्षारतोयवत्।
नीलमेहेन नीलाभं कालमेही मसीनिभम्॥13॥
हारिद्रमेही कटुकं हरिद्रासंनिभं दुहत्।
वित्रं माजिष्ठमेहेन मञ्जिष्ठासलिलोपमम्॥14॥

Ma.Ni. – 33/13-15

- **Ksharameha** – The odour, colour, taste, quality and texture of urine resemble to a *Kshara* is termed as *Ksharameha*.
- **Nilameha** – The colour of urine will be blue in *Nilameha*.
- **Kala Meha** – The colour of urine will black in *Kala Meha*.
- **Haridra Meha** – The colour of urine is yellow like turmeric powder mixed in water. It is pungent in nature and burning sensation during micturition.
- **Manjishtha Meha** – The urine of the patient resembles the decoction of *Manjishtha* (*Rubia cordifolia*) i.e. bright pink in colour. It also emits foul smell and amount of urine passed will be more when compared to other varieties of *Prameha*.
- **Rakta Meha** – The urine of the patient resembles the colour of blood. This is emitting foul smell, salty and hot in touch.

वसामेही वसामिश्रं वसानं मूत्रयेन्मुहुः॥15॥

मज्जाभं मज्जमिश्रं वा मज्जमेही मुहुर्मुहुः।

कषायं मधुरं रूक्षं क्षौद्रमेहं वदेदुधः॥16॥

हस्ती मत्त इवाजत्रं मूत्रं वेगविवर्जितम्॥

सलसीकं विबद्धं च हस्तिमेही प्रमेहति॥17॥

Ma.Ni. – 33/15-17

1. Vasa Meha

- The urine of the patient gets mixed with oily like substance called *Vasa* and gets excreted frequently in large quantity.

2. Majja Meha

- The urine of the patient gets mixed with *Majja* and this will be eliminated through urine.

3. Hasti Meha

- The frequency and volume of urine is profound that it resembles the urine of elephant. The consistency of the fluid is like *Lasika*.
- This is manifested in an individual due to the dominance of *Vata Dosha*.

4. Madhumeha or Kshoudra Meha

- The urine of the patient will have *Kashaya* and *Madhura Rasa* in *Mutra*.
- *Ojas* will be excreted in this disease. The urine will be thick, turbid and honey like sweet.

Upadrava²⁷ of Prameha

Upadrava of Kaphaja Prameha:

अविपाको रुचिश्छर्दिर्निद्रा कासः सपीनसः।

उपद्रवाः प्रजायन्ते मेहानां कफजन्मनाम्॥18॥

Ma.Ni. – 33/18

- Impaired digestion²⁸

- Tastelessness²⁹

- Vomiting³⁰

- Excess sleep³¹

- Cough³²

- Running nose

Upadrava of Pittaja Prameha

वस्तिमेहनयोस्तोदो मुष्कावदरणं ज्वरः।

दाहस्तृष्णाऽम्लिका मूर्च्छा विभेदः पित्तजन्मनाम्॥19॥

Ma.Ni. – 33/19

- Pricking type of pain in the *Basti* (lower abdomen) region

- Pricking type of pain in the *genital region*³³

- Destruction of scrotum

- Raised body temperature³⁴

- Burning sensation³⁵

- Thirst³⁶

- Sour eructations³⁷

- Altered state of consciousness³⁸

²⁷ When you speak of Upadrava of Prameha, it should involve Medovaha and Mutravaha in particular, it should have Prabhuta and Avila Mutra-ta. Ayurveda textbooks say the involvement of Medas, Rakta, Shukra, Ambu, Vasa, Lasika, Majja or/ and Mamsa may be observed during the manifestation and progression of the disease. In case of Kaphaja Prameha, involvement of Lasika, Medas, Mamsa may be observed, whereas in Pittaja Prameha, involvement of Yakrit and Pliha along with Rakta may be seen and in Vataja Prameha, involvement of Vasa and Majja can be witnessed.

²⁸ Avipaka refers to indigestion. It can happen because of either Kapha or Pitta or Vata abnormal functioning. As per fundamentals of Ayurveda, Ushma, Vayu, Kleda, Sneha, Kala and Samayoga are necessary for proper digestion of ingested food. If there is any disturbance in Ushma quality, indigestion may occur as a result of Pitta abnormality. In case of Vayu abnormal function, the person may have abnormal Prana, Samana or Apana Vata, thereby indigestion may occur as a result of abnormal Vata and when Kleda and Sneha qualities of Ahara Parinamakara Bhava are functioning abnormally, the person may have indigestion due to Kapha Dosha abnormal function.

• When the person is suffering from Kaphaja Prameha, Kleda and Sneha qualities may become abnormal leading to the manifestation of Avipaka.

²⁹ Presence of tastelessness implies that poor autonomic nervous dysfunction. This may lead to poor functioning of salivary glands. As we are going to have dominance of Kapha Dosha during the progression of the disease, parasympathetic nervous system activation may occur which may lead to tastelessness.

³⁰ As there is Kapha Dosha dominance, there will be parasympathetic nervous stimulation, there will be excess secretion in alimentary canal, (in mouth, stomach, small intestine). As there is more secretion in the upper alimentary canal, that will lead to more stretching of the alimentary canal, which may lead to appearance of vomiting.

³¹ Due to Kapha vitiation, an individual may have parasympathetic activation. Excess indulgence in sleep may be a contributory factor for parasympathetic nervous stimulation.

³² These are the symptoms observed in upper alimentary canal dysfunction.

³³ These symptoms may indicate the ongoing inflammatory pathology in the affected region.

³⁴ The presence of raised body temperature implies the ongoing infective pathology in the urinary system.

³⁵ Burning sensation may occur in the genital region or in skin of the body. Presence of burning sensation during micturition indicates the infective pathology afflicting urethra.

• Burning sensation in the skin implies diabetic neuropathy observed as a complication of diabetes mellitus.

³⁶ Thirst may be perceived by the patients when there is shrinkage of either intravascular, interstitial or intracellular compartments.

³⁷ Sour eructations indicate the excess of gastric juice secretion in the stomach.

³⁸ Altered state of consciousness may be seen in either poor blood circulation to the central nervous system or abnormal proportion of either

- Unformed stools³⁹

Upadrava of Vataja Prameha

वातजानामुदावर्तः कम्पनहलोलताः।

शूलमुन्निद्रता शोषः कासः श्वासश्च जायते॥20॥ Ma.Ni. – 33/20

- Udavarta⁴⁰ – reverse movement of Apana vata
- Involuntary movements⁴¹
- Stiffness in the chest region⁴²
- Desire to take all types of Rasa during the food intake
- Pricking type of pain in the abdomen⁴³
- Excess sleep
- Dryness of the body parts⁴⁴
- Cough
- Breathing discomfort⁴⁵

Sadhyasadyata of Prameha

साध्याः कफोत्था दश, पित्तजाः षट् याप्या, न साध्यः पवनाच्चतुष्कः।

समक्रियत्वाद्विषमक्रियत्वा- न्महात्ययत्वाच्च यथाक्रमं ते॥7॥

Ca.Ci. – 6/7

जातः प्रमेही मधुमेहिनो वा न साध्य उक्तः स हि बीजदोषात्।

ये चापि केचित् कुलजा विकारा भवन्ति तांश्च प्रवदन्त्य साध्यान्॥57॥

Ca.Ci. – 6/57

सपूर्वरूपाः कफपित्तमेहाः क्रमेण ये वातकृताश्च मेहाः।

साध्या न ते, पित्तकृतास्तु याप्याः, साध्यास्तु मेदो यदि न प्रदुष्टम्॥56॥

Ca.Ci. – 6/56

nutrients or electrolytes.

- 39 The presence of unformed stools implies poor intestinal absorption and this can be attributable to autonomic dysfunction. The normal nature of stool is having pultaceous consistency. When the individual is having digestive impairment may be in the form of either lack of alimentary secretion or poor motility in alimentary canal or hampered assimilation in the alimentary canal.
- 40 When an individual is presented with Udavarta, that may indicate the increase of Ruksha Guna in the body or disturbed Chala Guna in the body. In this occasion, the person will have Vata vitiation limited to Apana Vata i.e. the person may have abnormal movements of urine, faecal matter or menstruation etc.
- 41 The presence of involuntary movements refers to the increase of Chala Guna in the body. This may imply the abnormal neurological function.
- 42 This may imply the increase of Ruksha Guna in the body. This is indicative of Stabdghata, abnormal function of vitiated Vata Dosha.
- 43 Pricking type of pain implies the vitiation of Vata Dosha in the body.
- 44 Dryness of body parts implies that the increase of Ruksha Guna of Vata Dosha in the body. It indicates the shrinking of intravascular, interstitial or intracellular compartments.
- 45 This indicates the abnormal respiratory function in the body.
- 46 The curability and incurability of the illness is based on the nature of Dosha vitiation and line of treatment in general. It is being said that Prameha is a disease of abnormal Kapha Dosha increase. That implies that we have to follow the diet and treatment related to the decrease of Kapha Dosha from the body. In case of Kaphaja Prameha, the nature of Dosha vitiation and line of treatment of Prameha is similar, that is why the Kaphaja Prameha is easily curable. In case of Pittaja Prameha, Snigdha is the quality similar to Pitta and Kapha, that is the reason Pittaja Prameha is manageable and in case of Vataja Prameha, all the qualities are opposite to the Kapha and treatment in Vataja Prameha will decrease Kapha Dosha and increase Vata Dosha in the body, that is the reason, Vataja Prameha are incurable in nature.
- 47 Ayurveda literatures say that Prameha is considered as Adhyatmika Vikara further subcategorised under Adibala Pravritta Vikara wherein the deformity is seen in either Shukra and Shonita of the parents.
- 48 For example, Dantadinam Maladhyatva (accumulation of waste products such as excess wax in the ears, excess accumulation of tartar in the teeth etc, leads to the proliferation of infection. Whenever, there is infection, that will lead to the increase of glucose in the body as more energy is required to combat the condition. If the person is not taking care of this symptom, there will be hyperglycemia most of the times. Thus, in this situation, hyperglycemia cannot be checked until and unless we give more attention to personal hygiene.
- 49 This may suggest gradual depletion of physical strength (Dhatu Kshaya) of the individual and the person is unable to withstand the potency of the medicine administered to the patient. That is the reason, the disease is considered as Asadhyata in nature.

Asadhyata Lakshana of Prameha

यथोक्तोपद्रवाविष्टमतिप्रसृतमेव च।

पिडकापीडितं गाढः प्रमेहो हन्ति मानवम्॥21॥

Ma.Ni. – 33/21

- 10 types of Kaphaja Prameha are considered as Sadhya⁴⁶ (easily curable),
- 6 types of Pittaja Prameha are considered as Yapy (manageable) and
- 4 types of Vataja Prameha are considered as Asadhyata (incurable).
- When the person is suffering from Prameha since birth and if there is family history of Prameha⁴⁷, such disease is considered to be Asadhyata (incurable).
- When there are Purvarupa of Prameha⁴⁸ are observed in the patients, such type of Prameha is considered as Asadhyata (incurable).
- When there is sequential involvement of Kapha, Pitta and Vata during the pathogenesis of Prameha, such type of Prameha is Asadhyata (incurable)⁴⁹ in nature.
- When the person is presented with multiple Upadrava (complications) and when the person is presented with Prameha Pidaka (carbuncles), such type of Prameha is considered to be Asadhyata in nature.

Key summary of the chapter

- Prameha is a spectrum of diseases which involve Medovaha and Mutravaha Srotas. This is characterised by Prabhuta Mutrata (increased quantity of urine is passed in 24 hours) and Avila Mutrata (turbid urine passed). Amashaya is the Udbhava Sthana of the disease, Sanchara Sthana is Sarvasharira and Vyakta Sthana is Mutra. Atipravritti is the type of Srotodushti observed in this group of diseases.
- प्रकर्षेण प्रभूतं प्रचुरं वारंवारं वा मूत्रत्यागं करोति यस्मिन् रोगे स प्रमेहः॥
- It implies that the frequent passage of either large or small quantity of urine is termed as Prameha. मा.नि. - 33/1, मधु.
- Asyasukha (consuming the food liked by oneself frequently without proper control), Svapnasukha (sleeping excessively), Dadhi (curds) etc Kapha provoking foods and drinks will be leading to the vitiation of Kapha Dosha, sedentary lifestyle.
- Prabhuta Mutrata (increased frequency of urine in 24 hours) and Avila Mutrata (passage of turbid urine) are Pratyatma Lakshana (cardinal features) of Prameha.
- 20 types of Prameha⁵⁰ are mentioned. 10 types of Kaphaja Prameha, 6 types of Pittaja Prameha and 4 types of Vataja Prameha are mentioned in Ayurveda treatises. Among these 20 types, Kaphaja, Pittaja and Vataja Prameha are considered as Sadhya (curable), Yasya (manageable) and Asadya (incurable) respectively based on Samakriyatva, Vishamakriyatva and Mahatyayatva. These categories are made on the basis of nature of treatment and status of Dosha vitiation in the progression of the disease.

Self-Assessment: Questions for Reviews

Long essay questions

- Define Prameha. Explain the Nidana, Samprapti, Purvarupa, Rupa, Bheda, Upadrava and Sadhyasadyata of Prameha
- Explain the Nidana Panchaka of Prameha in detail.

Short essay questions

- Explain the Sadhyasadyata of Prameha
- Explain Kaphaja Prameha
- Explain Nidana of Prameha
- Explain Purvarupa of Prameha
- Explain Samprapti and Samprapti Ghataka of Prameha

Short answers

- Write the definition of Prameha
- Write the Pratyatma Lakshana of Prameha
- Enumerate Kaphaja Prameha
- Enumerate Pittaja Prameha
- Write Purvarupa of Prameha
- Write the Sadhyasadyata of Prameha
- What is Madhumeha?

MCQs

- Shanairmeha is included inPrameha.
 - Kaphaja;
 - Pittaja;

- Vataja;
- Sannipataja

Answer: (a)

- Mahatyayatva is the term used in relation with which of the following type of Prameha?

- Vataja;
- Pittaja;
- Kaphaja;
- Not mentioned in Ayurveda textbooks

Answer: (a)

- The number of Pittaja Prameha is

- 10;
- 6;
- 4;
- 20

Answer: (b)

- Madhumeha is considered as a type ofPrameha.

- Kaphaja;
- Pittaja;
- Vataja;
- Sannipataja

Answer: (c)

- Prabhuta Mutrata isof Prameha.

- Purvarupa;
- Nidana;
- Upadrava;
- Pratyatma Lakshana

Answer: (d)

⁵⁰ Prameha is Kapha dominant disease by default. Kaphahara line of treatment is advised in case of any type of Prameha as per above said principle. When one administers the Kaphahara line of treatment, that vitiate Vata Dosha in the body. That is the reason, in case of Kaphaja Prameha, the person responds to the Prameha management very easily, in case of Pittaja Prameha, the patient responds to the treatment with difficulty and in case of Vataja Prameha, the person is not responding to the treatment which may vitiate Vata Dosha.

6. Which one of the following is not included in Kaphaja Prameha?

- Sandraprasadameha;
- Shukrameha;
- Madhumeha;
- Ikshumeha

Answer: (c)

7. Which one of the following is included in Pittaja Prameha?

- Haridrameha;
- Vasameha;
- Udakameha;
- Hastimeha

Answer: (a)

8. Which of the following Srotas is involved in Prameha?

- Medovaha Srotas;
- Mutravaha Srotas;
- Both a and b;
- None of the above

Answer: (c)

9. Which of the following Srotodushti Prakara is observed in the patient of Prameha?

- Atipravritti;
- Sanga;
- Sanga and Vimargagamana;
- Siragranthi

Answer: (a)

10. Sankhya Samprapti of Prameha is

- 20;
- 10;
- 6;
- 4

Answer: (a)

11. All are the types of Vataja Prameha except

- Vasa Meha;
- Madhumeha;
- Majja Meha;
- Udaka Meha

Answer: (d)

12. Following types of Prameha are not curable

- 10 types of Kaphaja Prameha;
- 6 types of Pittaja Prameha;
- 4 types of Vataja Prameha;
- All of the above

Answer: (c)

13. Urine of Kalameha is like

- Jala;
- Sura;
- Mashi;
- Kshara; e. Haridra

Answer: (c)

14. Types of Prameha Pidaka as per Charaka

- 10;
- 7;
- 8;
- 9

Answer: (b)

15. Kshoudra Meha is the synonym of

- Sandrameha;
- Hastimeha;

- Madhumeha;
- Surameha

Answer: (c)

16. As per Ayurveda literature, the Adhishthana of Prameha is

- Vrikka;
- Kloma;
- Basti;
- Yakrit

Answer: (c)

17. Bahudrava Shleshma Visheshah is the term specifically related to which of the following disease?

- Gulma;
- Kushtha;
- Jvara;
- Prameha

Answer: (d)

18. Amlameha is specifically mentioned by

- Charaka;
- Sushruta;
- Both Charaka and Sushruta;
- None of the above

Answer: (b)

19. Yappa Prameha is

- Madhumeha;
- Raktameha;
- Udakameha;
- Lalameha

Answer: (b)

20. Dantadinam Maladhyatva isof Prameha.

- Rupa;
- Purvarupa;
- Upadrava;
- Arishta

Answer: (b)

Chapter resources

- ⊗ <https://my.clevelandclinic.org/health/diseases/15234-hematuria>
- ⊗ Madhava Nidana 33rd chapter – Prameha Nidana
- ⊗ Charaka Samhita Nidana Sthana – 4th chapter, Prameha Nidana Adhyaya
- ⊗ Charaka Samhita, Chikitsa Sthana, 6th chapter, Prameha Chikitsa Adhyaya
- ⊗ Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- ⊗ The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- ⊗ Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- ⊗ Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- ⊗ Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006